EUROLIBRARY

Full guide
eurolibrary.eu/human-library

Human Library checklist

Everything to prepare, run and close a Human Library, from three weeks before to the day after. Tick each box as you go.

Three weeks before

- [ ] Hold a full group meeting of 60 to 90 minutes: ice breakers, the project, the method, its roles and principles.
- [ ] Agree the date of each team meeting before the call ends.
- [ ] Choose the venues and ask permission: squares, schools, libraries, community centres or other public spaces.
- [ ] Decide whether each event is open to the public or by invitation.

Two weeks before

- [ ] Go deeper into the method with each team: ethics, storytelling structure, and the roles of books and readers.
- [ ] Help each participant choose their story and decide their emotional boundaries.
- [ ] Share draft stories and give each other peer feedback.
- [ ] Form the working groups: books, librarians, promoters and dictionaries.

One week before

- [ ] Collect every book's title and short review.
- [ ] Compile the catalogue, with at least six books for a small library.
- [ ] Prepare a digital version with a QR code and a few printed copies.
- [ ] Prepare signs, posters, leaflets and badges or T-shirts for each role.
- [ ] Run a short training for books and librarians.

The day before

- [ ] Promote the event online, in mailing lists and on social media.
- [ ] Gather all the materials in one place.
- [ ] Do a general trial: act out a whole loan from reception to feedback.
- [ ] Organise snacks and drinks for the reading space.

Three hours before

- [ ] Set up the three spaces: reception, bookshelf and reading space.
- [ ] Start the promotion around the venue.
- [ ] Hold a last team meeting to agree roles, timings and signals.
- [ ] Check the consent you need for photos and for collecting emails.

During the library

- [ ] Run reception: registration, rules and catalogue.
- [ ] Time every loan and note who borrowed which book.
- [ ] Let books rest between loans.
- [ ] Keep activities going for people who are not reading: games for children, promotion, short videos.

After the library

- [ ] Thank books, readers and the venue.
- [ ] Gather feedback from participants and readers.
- [ ] Share photos, videos and podcasts with readers who agreed to receive them.
- [ ] Write down what worked and what to change next time.

What you need

- [ ] Coloured paper and flipcharts
- [ ] Markers, pens, scissors and tape
- [ ] Badges or T-shirts for each role
- [ ] Tables and chairs
- [ ] Paper tablecloths to write on
- [ ] Printed catalogue and a QR code
- [ ] Signs, posters or a roll up banner
- [ ] Snacks, coffee and water
- [ ] A timer
- [ ] A sign in sheet

The six rules of the library

Timed loans. A loan lasts around 20 to 30 minutes, and never more than 30. It can end earlier.

Register first. Readers sign in at reception, receive the instructions and accept them explicitly.

Your own story. Books speak from the "I". No generalisations, no apologies and no attempt to convince.

The right to say no. A book can skip any question and end the loan if the conversation goes somewhere unwanted.

Two readers at most. To keep it a conversation and not a lecture, no more than two readers per book at once.

Return it with care. Readers hand the book back as they found it: treated with courtesy, kindness and confidentiality.

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